A Resolution on the Disciplined Use of the Congressional Majority

This resolution states the position of the essay "The Purpose of the Power" in a form other committees can amend line by line. Substitute your committee's name in the first Resolved clause.

Whereas on November 3, 2026, voters gave Democrats control of both the House and the Senate, while the President retains the veto and neither chamber holds the two-thirds needed to override it; and

Whereas limited power makes the choice of priorities more important, not less, and the test of every hearing, subpoena, and bill should be how much it matters, not how many wins it produces or how easily they come; and

Whereas lowering the cost of living is a clear part of the mandate, and 90 percent of Election Day voters polled also called corruption a crucial or major problem; and

Whereas sixty deaths in ICE detention have been reported in this presidential term, the 37 in fiscal year 2026 were the most in the agency's history, and federal immigration agents shot and killed two U.S. citizens in Minneapolis in January 2026; and

Whereas Congress's own auditors found that DOGE gave too little information to verify 96 percent of the grant savings it reported; and

Whereas USAID has been dismantled, with researchers projecting more than 14 million additional deaths by 2030 if the cuts stand, and the Department of Education is being parceled out to other agencies though Congress kept funding it; and

Whereas a foreign buyer reportedly paid $500 million for 49 percent of the cryptocurrency company owned by the President's family, in a deal signed four days before the inauguration; and

Whereas the law requires release of the Epstein files, and the Justice Department has not released them in full; and

Whereas the conflict with Iran, begun without a vote of Congress, had killed 18 American service members by mid-September 2026 and cost $38 billion by August 2026, military strikes on boats in the Caribbean and the Pacific have killed more than 200 people without authorization from Congress, and no full public accounting exists for more than $13 billion in Venezuelan oil the President says the United States has sold; and

Whereas Congress's own auditors have found the Administration's pocket rescissions unlawful, the Supreme Court has struck down tariffs imposed under emergency powers, and courts have repeatedly ruled against the Administration's pressure on states, law firms, and universities;

Now, therefore, be it resolved that the Andover Democratic Town Committee calls on the Democratic majorities in Congress to accept the power voters gave them and to use it with discipline, pairing action on the cost of living with oversight aimed at the most consequential abuses; and

Resolved, that Congress should investigate deaths and shootings in immigration enforcement, follow the money appropriated to ICE and CBP, and condition that money on reforms beginning with body cameras and visible identification for agents; and

Resolved, that Congress should establish what DOGE did and what it cost, document the damage to USAID, the Department of Education, and other dismantled programs, and rebuild what it can in law; and

Resolved, that Congress should pursue corruption before incompetence, beginning with the President's chief aides and family, through sworn testimony and documents, and should ban its own members from trading stocks; and

Resolved, that Congress should secure release of the complete Epstein files, investigate the Justice Department's handling of them, and leave questions of individual criminal guilt to prosecutors; and

Resolved, that Congress should reclaim its war powers, examine the conduct and cost of the Iran and Venezuela operations, require a full accounting of the Venezuelan oil money, and investigate anyone positioned to profit; and

Resolved, that Congress should write limits into law by strengthening the Impoundment Control Act, protecting inspectors general from removal, enforcing the Constitution's emoluments clauses, and restoring its own authority over war; and

Resolved, that impeachment remains a constitutional tool for serious, proven offenses, and is neither the first resort nor a substitute for this work; and

Resolved, that Republicans who join this work are welcome, and should be judged by their votes rather than their expressions of concern; and

Resolved, that the purpose of this majority is not future Democratic victories for their own sake but the restoration of government of the people, by the people, and for the people, and not one run for the President's wealthy cronies; and

Resolved, that this resolution be sent to the other Democratic town committees of the 4th Senate District and to the district's members of the Democratic State Central Committee, with the request that the state party adopt it and forward it to the Democratic National Committee.